IELTS ACADEMIC · STUDENT WORKSHEET

IELTS Academic Set 37

All sections

Name: _____ Date: _____

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Work through each IELTS part in order. Reading passages stay with their questions; charts and diagrams appear next to their tasks. Open the live practice page for Listening audio and Speaking recordings.

Staff solutions and scripts are supplied separately.

Listening

Use the separately supplied audio. Write one response for each question.

You will hear four recordings. Each recording is played once.

Answer Questions 1-40. Follow the instruction and word limit printed for each group.

At the end, check your answers before submitting.

Part 1

Questions 1-6

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

1. Customer surname: _____

2. Machine model: Alder _____

3. Main problem: uneven _____

4. Thread breaks beside the _____

5. Preferred appointment: Tuesday _____

6. Collection charge: £_____

Questions 7-10

Choose the correct answer.

7. Why does Eleanor choose home collection?

A it includes free replacement parts

B the machine is difficult to carry

C the workshop is closed this week

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8. How long will the initial inspection take?

A one working day

B two working days

C three working days

9. What will Hugh send before any extra work begins?

A a written estimate

B a video of the mechanism

C a replacement warranty

10. Which item should Eleanor bring separately?

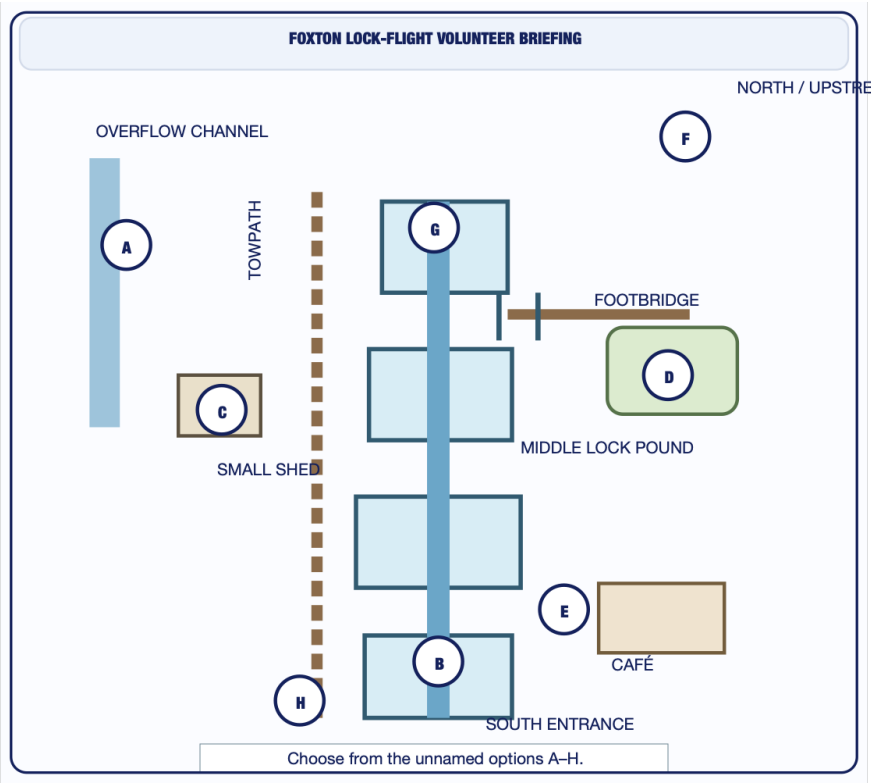
A the extension table

B the bobbin case

C the instruction book

Part 2

Candidate map / plan



Questions 11-16

Choose the correct answer.

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11. Tool store

- **A** Location A
- **B** Location B
- **C** Location C
- **D** Location D
- **E** Location E
- **F** Location F
- **G** Location G
- **H** Location H

12. Upper gate work area

13. Spillway viewpoint

14. Sign-in tent

15. Rest area

16. Lower chamber

Questions 17-20

Choose the correct answer.

17. removing litter from the towpath

- **A** Team A
- **B** Team B
- **C** Team C
- **D** Team D
- **E** Team E
- **F** Team F
- **G** Team G

18. repainting safety rails

19. recording visitor numbers

20. checking wildlife screens

Part 3

Questions 21-25

Choose the correct answer.

21. What was the clearest weakness in the first transfer?

- **A** the patient was given too much information
- **B** the chair was not secured first
- **C** the trainees stood too far apart

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22. What does Priya say about the footplates?

A they were set at the wrong height

B they should have remained in place

C they were moved too late

23. Why will the team use a side camera?

A to reveal distances hidden from the front

B to record the trainee's facial expression

C to avoid filming the wheelchair

24. What change to spoken instructions do they agree on?

A use technical terms consistently

B give one instruction at a time

C avoid speaking during movement

25. What will happen before the next assessed attempt?

A the tutor will demonstrate alone

B a different wheelchair will be supplied

C the trainees will rehearse without filming

Questions 26-30

Choose the correct answer.

26. drafts the revised sequence checklist

A Aled

B Priya

C Dr Hume

D peer observer

27. redesigns the communication column

28. chooses the second camera position

29. tests the form during rehearsal

30. leads the final verbal summary

Part 4

Questions 31-36

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

31. Birds respond mainly to their _____ rather than to the whole flock.

32. Simple _____ can produce an organised group pattern.

33. In the teaching simulation, flocks may become denser under _____.

34. A turn may begin among birds near the _____ of the flock.

35. The change in direction travels as a turning _____.

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36. Researchers used _____ synchronised cameras.

Questions 37-40

Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

37. Image matching provides an estimate of each bird's _____.

38. Besides flock size, the simulated model includes _____ as a separate input.

39. A sudden turn does not always indicate a _____.

40. The strongest explanation links measured movement with a _____.

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Reading

Read the three passages and answer Questions 1-40. Follow the word limit shown for each completion task.

The bark that grows back

A A cork oak is not cut down when its commercial material is collected. Workers remove part of the thick outer bark, while the living tissues that move water and nutrients remain on the tree. The exposed trunk looks startlingly red at first, but a new protective layer begins to form. This capacity for bark regrowth makes cork a renewable forest product, although renewal is neither immediate nor automatic. A careless cut can penetrate too deeply, and stripping at the wrong moment can leave the tree vulnerable. The harvest is therefore better understood as skilled surgery than as ordinary logging.

B Before an axe touches the trunk, harvesters judge whether the bark is ready to separate. Warm, dry conditions help the outer layer lift from the tissues beneath it; resistance at the first incision is a warning to stop. Age and trunk size also matter because young trees must first build a sufficiently thick shield. Once production has begun, another crop is not taken every year. Managers wait through a multi-year debarking interval so that a usable layer can develop. The calendar supplies a guide, but the tree's condition decides whether removal should proceed.

C A specialist first makes vertical cuts through the cork and then joins them with shorter horizontal cuts. A flat edge is eased under the bark, allowing broad curved planks to be levered away without injuring the cork cambium. The easiest sheet to remove is not necessarily the best: haste can tear the material or scar the living surface. Around branches and irregular trunks, smaller pieces are taken instead of forcing a single large slab. Marks painted on the trunk record the harvest year, enabling crews to distinguish trees that are due from their neighbours.

D The rough bark taken from a tree for the first time is usually too irregular for the most exacting products. Later harvests become more uniform as the tree produces a smoother layer. Even then, each plank varies in thickness, density and visible defects. Sorting starts in the woodland and continues after processing. This is why cork should not be described as one homogeneous commodity: material that is unsuitable for a single-piece bottle closure may still be ground for composite products, insulation or flooring. A quality hierarchy reduces waste by matching different grades to different uses.

E Fresh planks contain moisture and retain the curve of the trunk. In a seasoning yard they are stacked above the soil with spaces for air to circulate. The period outdoors allows their moisture content to become more stable and exposes pieces that warp or decay. Processors later heat the cork in water, which cleans it, increases its flexibility and helps flatten the curve. The material is then rested again before trimming. Seasoning is not simply storage between harvest and manufacture; it is a stage in which the behaviour of the raw material becomes easier to assess.

F Cork production also shapes the woodland around the tree. In traditional agroforestry mosaics, cork oaks may share space with grazing animals, crops and other tree species. Because a productive tree remains standing for repeated harvests, owners have an incentive to retain mature woodland rather than clear it after one crop. Yet commercial value alone does not guarantee good stewardship. Excessive grazing can prevent young trees from replacing old ones, while badly timed stripping can weaken the existing stock. Renewable harvest depends on patient management across generations, not merely on the biological ability to regrow bark.

G Demand for bottle closures once dominated the industry, but alternative closures created pressure to find broader markets. Producers responded by using granulated cork in construction, transport and design. Diversification can make a harvesting region less dependent on one product, although it cannot remove the long delay between a management decision and its consequences. A neglected seedling today may mean a shortage of mature trees decades later. The central lesson of cork forestry is therefore temporal: skilled removal, careful seasoning and inventive manufacturing operate on different schedules, all of which must fit the much slower life of the tree.

H Much of the judgement involved is difficult to reduce to a written timetable. Experienced harvesters notice how a blade enters, how a sheet begins to lift and whether a particular trunk should be left for another season. Training therefore combines explicit safety rules with observation beside skilled crews. Mechanisation can move and process heavy planks, but the decision to continue a cut remains local. Preserving that knowledge is part of maintaining the resource, because a mistake made in minutes can affect several future harvests.

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Signals carried by silk

A An orb web is often pictured as a passive net, yet for its owner it is also an extended sensory surface. A struggling insect, a potential mate and a gust of wind all set silk moving. The spider, usually waiting at the hub or in a retreat, receives those movements through its legs. Because eyesight may contribute little at night, vibration can reveal where an event occurred and what kind of event it is. The difficulty is that several sources may act at once. Useful information must be recovered from a structure already trembling with environmental noise.

B Signals do not spread uniformly across a web. Radial threads link the hub to the frame and can carry movement rapidly towards the spider, while the sticky spiral crosses those routes and helps restrain prey. Tension, thickness and the junctions between strands alter how strongly a pulse arrives. A signal entering near one radial line may reach the hub with a different pattern from an equal signal elsewhere. Thus the web's geometry contributes directional information. It is not a neutral cable that simply preserves whatever vibration was produced at the source.

C Different events tend to generate different mixtures of frequency, duration and rhythm, but no single frequency acts as a permanent label. The movements of a trapped fly change as it tires; wind can produce both slow swaying and sharper pulses; and courtship signals vary between species. The spider must interpret a combination rather than recognise one magic tone. Experiments show why broad claims are risky: a response observed on one web, under one tension, may not transfer unchanged to another. Signal identity emerges from the source and the transmitting structure together.

D A male approaching a female's web faces a communication problem. He must create a pattern that the female recognises as courtship rather than as the movement of prey. Repeated pulses and pauses can form a species-typical rhythm, but the route through the web may distort it. If wind noise masks part of the sequence, the male may repeat or intensify the display. The female's response is evidence that information survived transmission; it does not prove that the waveform at her legs was identical to the one produced by the male.

E Researchers separate source from structure by introducing repeatable vibrations. A mechanical device can deliver the same controlled pulse at several contact points while a remote sensor measures what reaches the hub. Differences in arrival time and amplitude then reveal attenuation along particular routes. Alternatively, a pulse can be kept at one point while thread tension is adjusted. These designs create comparisons that a naturally struggling insect cannot provide. Their precision has a cost, however, because attaching equipment or changing tension may itself alter the web being measured.

F Laser-based instruments can record silk movement without touching it, reducing one form of disturbance. Even so, the beam samples selected locations rather than the entire three-dimensional structure. Laboratory frames also make webs easier to compare but may constrain the shapes spiders would build outdoors. Field recording preserves natural architecture and wind exposure, yet the source of every vibration is harder to identify. No method eliminates interpretation. Strong studies combine controlled trials with observations of intact webs and state clearly which inferences each design permits.

G The web is not fixed after construction. A spider can replace damaged silk, tighten some lines and remove others. These changes affect prey capture, but they may also tune the information reaching the animal. That possibility reverses a familiar assumption: instead of treating the web as an imperfect channel that the spider tolerates, it treats construction as part of sensing. Evidence remains incomplete because repair responds to hunger, weather and damage as well as communication. Nonetheless, behaviour and architecture cannot be cleanly separated.

H Engineers interested in lightweight sensors study webs because a distributed network can reveal both a disturbance and its location. The biological example does not offer a design ready to copy. Silk is variable, the builder continuously maintains it, and interpretation occurs in a nervous system rather than in the material alone. Its value lies in a principle: a structure may carry information precisely because its components respond differently. In an artificial network, as in a web, variation can be a source of data if the geometry and the signal are analysed together.

I Researchers still disagree about how much of a spider's discrimination comes from the physical filtering of silk and how much from later neural processing. Answering that question requires simultaneous records of the introduced disturbance, movement at several web locations and the animal's response. Comparisons across webs also need measurements of tension and topology rather than a photograph alone. The next advances will probably come from joining behavioural experiments with structural models, not from treating either kind of evidence as sufficient by itself.

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Measuring the ordinary day

A Governments and researchers want to know how people divide a day among paid work, care, travel, rest and leisure. Those categories inform transport planning, labour policy and estimates of unpaid activity. Yet daily life does not arrive already labelled. A person may supervise a child while answering work messages, or travel while listening to a lecture. Any time-use method must turn overlapping experience into countable units. The apparent precision of a table therefore begins with a conceptual choice about what counts as the main activity.

B In a time diary, participants record activities in intervals and often add location, companions or a secondary activity. The method allows people to describe purpose: a still hour might be meditation, illness or waiting for a repair. Diaries can also capture care and domestic work that leave few digital traces. Their weakness is not simply forgetfulness. Completing frequent entries imposes a recall burden, while completing them later encourages reconstruction according to routine. Participants may round times, merge short events or omit actions they consider trivial.

C Experience-sampling systems ask brief questions at selected times, usually through a phone. A prompt close to an event can reduce the distance between action and report, and it can collect mood as well as activity. However, an alert may interrupt the very activity being studied. People also ignore prompts when busy, producing missing intervals that are not random. If a commuter answers reliably but a nurse cannot respond during demanding work, the resulting record may exaggerate one kind of day and underrepresent another.

D Passive sensors appear to avoid reporting effort. Accelerometers register movement; location services trace changes of place; wearable cameras sample scenes. None observes an activity category directly. Little movement could indicate desk work, sleep or sitting on a bus, while a journey recorded by location does not disclose its purpose. Algorithms infer labels from patterns, so coding rules become part of the measurement. A model trained on one population may misclassify routines organised differently elsewhere.

E Device records can expose transitions that a diary smooths away, but increased resolution should not be confused with completeness. A camera may be covered, a battery may fail and an indoor location signal may disappear. Sensors worn by one person also capture fragments of other people's lives. Those bystanders did not necessarily consent to being recorded. Researchers can blur images, remove sound and let participants delete sensitive segments, but each protection also changes the evidence available for analysis.

F When a diary and a sensor disagree, it is tempting to treat the device as the objective referee. That conclusion is often mistaken. A participant may correctly report “caring for a parent” while an accelerometer records sitting; the two measures describe different dimensions of the same period. Validation should ask whether a method measures the concept required by the study, not merely whether it matches another instrument. Disagreement can be diagnostic, revealing where categories, purposes and bodily movement diverge.

G Combining methods can reduce some weaknesses if their roles are specified in advance. A diary may supply purpose, a sensor may identify forgotten transitions, and a follow-up interview may explain unusual gaps. This is not a licence to collect everything. Each additional stream increases participant burden, privacy risk and the analyst's opportunity to choose a convenient interpretation. A defensible mixed design begins with a limited question and retains only data needed to answer it.

H The attraction of passive sensing is understandable: it promises a continuous record without a participant repeatedly stopping to write. But continuity is not neutrality. Devices are better at some bodies, settings and behaviours than others, and their categories embody assumptions about a worthwhile use of time. Diaries make interpretation visible because a person supplies it; algorithms can hide interpretation behind a numerical label. The best method is therefore not the one that produces the most data, but the one whose errors, intrusions and definitions are acceptable for a stated social purpose.

I Method choice also affects who agrees to join a study. A person comfortable completing a paper diary may reject continuous location tracking, while another may prefer a sensor to repeated written entries. Offering meaningful choices can broaden participation, but different options complicate comparison. Researchers should record which groups select each route and test whether conclusions change when one route is analysed separately. Consent is not merely a form signed before measurement; it shapes the population from which the evidence is produced.

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1. Which paragraph explains why cork is divided into grades?

A Paragraph A
B Paragraph B
C Paragraph C
D Paragraph D
E Paragraph E
F Paragraph F
G Paragraph G
H Paragraph H

2. Which paragraph explains why harvesting cork is compared with surgery?

A Paragraph A
B Paragraph B
C Paragraph C
D Paragraph D
E Paragraph E
F Paragraph F
G Paragraph G
H Paragraph H

3. Which paragraph warns that biological renewal still requires long-term management?

A Paragraph A
B Paragraph B
C Paragraph C
D Paragraph D
E Paragraph E
F Paragraph F
G Paragraph G
H Paragraph H

4. Which paragraph outlines the order in which bark is detached?

A Paragraph A
B Paragraph B
C Paragraph C
D Paragraph D
E Paragraph E
F Paragraph F
G Paragraph G
H Paragraph H

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5. Which paragraph describes how readiness is judged at the tree?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

6. Which paragraph presents outdoor storage as an assessment stage?

A Paragraph A

B Paragraph B

C Paragraph C

D Paragraph D

E Paragraph E

F Paragraph F

G Paragraph G

H Paragraph H

7. The tissues that transport water and nutrients remain in the _____ during harvesting.

8. Resistance during the initial cut tells workers to _____.

9. Crews record the harvest year using marks on the _____.

10. Cork unsuitable for whole closures can be used in _____ products.

11. Planks are raised above the ground in a _____.

12. Too much grazing can prevent the establishment of _____.

13. A present failure to protect seedlings may produce a future shortage of _____.

14. An orb web functions only as a device for trapping prey.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

15. Radial threads can help indicate the direction from which a vibration originated.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

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16. Every species of spider uses one unique frequency to identify prey.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

17. The female receives an exact copy of the vibration produced by a courting male.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

18. Controlled pulses allow researchers to compare transmission routes.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

19. Laser instruments record movement at every point of a web simultaneously.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

20. Web repair is carried out only to improve communication.

TRUE

FALSE

NOT GIVEN

21. A web gives information about an event through movement received by the spider's _____.

22. Pulse strength at the hub is altered by tension, thickness and _____ between strands.

23. A courting male may repeat his display when parts are hidden by _____.

24. Scientists deliver an identical disturbance at different _____.

25. Laboratory frames may limit the _____ that spiders construct.

26. Engineers can treat variation as data when geometry is analysed together with the _____.

27. Paragraph B

i An entirely automatic classification

ii Devices observe patterns, not activities

iii Why continuous collection solves every problem

iv People provide purpose but may reconstruct events

v A method that avoids any interruption

vi The appropriate method depends on purpose and acceptable costs

vii Immediate prompts create their own missing data

viii Agreement as the only valid criterion

ix Different measurements can truthfully disagree

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28. Paragraph C

i An entirely automatic classification

ii Devices observe patterns, not activities

iii Why continuous collection solves every problem

iv People provide purpose but may reconstruct events

v A method that avoids any interruption

vi The appropriate method depends on purpose and acceptable costs

vii Immediate prompts create their own missing data

viii Agreement as the only valid criterion

ix Different measurements can truthfully disagree

29. Paragraph D

i An entirely automatic classification

ii Devices observe patterns, not activities

iii Why continuous collection solves every problem

iv People provide purpose but may reconstruct events

v A method that avoids any interruption

vi The appropriate method depends on purpose and acceptable costs

vii Immediate prompts create their own missing data

viii Agreement as the only valid criterion

ix Different measurements can truthfully disagree

30. Paragraph F

i An entirely automatic classification

ii Devices observe patterns, not activities

iii Why continuous collection solves every problem

iv People provide purpose but may reconstruct events

v A method that avoids any interruption

vi The appropriate method depends on purpose and acceptable costs

vii Immediate prompts create their own missing data

viii Agreement as the only valid criterion

ix Different measurements can truthfully disagree

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31. Paragraph H

- **i** An entirely automatic classification
- **ii** Devices observe patterns, not activities
- **iii** Why continuous collection solves every problem
- **iv** People provide purpose but may reconstruct events
- **v** A method that avoids any interruption
- **vi** The appropriate method depends on purpose and acceptable costs
- **vii** Immediate prompts create their own missing data
- **viii** Agreement as the only valid criterion
- **ix** Different measurements can truthfully disagree

32. Why are time-use categories described as conceptual choices?

- **A** They are selected by device manufacturers.
- **B** Real activities overlap and must be assigned to units.
- **C** They are identical in every national survey.
- **D** Participants refuse to record secondary activities.

33. What difficulty with experience sampling does the writer emphasise?

- **A** It cannot collect information about mood.
- **B** It always records events long after they occur.
- **C** Non-response may be related to the activity being measured.
- **D** It requires a wearable camera.

34. What does the example of caring for a parent demonstrate?

- **A** Self-reports are always more accurate than sensors.
- **B** Movement data should replace activity labels.
- **C** Care work is impossible to measure.
- **D** Two methods may capture different dimensions of one period.

35. What is the writer’s main recommendation for mixed designs?

- **A** Collect only streams needed for a defined question.
- **B** Retain every available record for future analysis.
- **C** Use sensors to correct all diary entries.
- **D** Avoid follow-up interviews.

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36. A diary can distinguish stillness caused by

- **A** produce missing intervals associated with demanding work.
- **B** remove the need to define an activity.
- **C** protect privacy while reducing the evidence retained.
- **D** prove that continuous data are neutral.
- **E** test whether a method measures the intended concept.
- **F** meditation, illness or waiting.
- **G** treat the device as an objective referee.
- **H** misclassify routines organised differently.

37. Ignored phone prompts may

- **A** produce missing intervals associated with demanding work.
- **B** remove the need to define an activity.
- **C** protect privacy while reducing the evidence retained.
- **D** prove that continuous data are neutral.
- **E** test whether a method measures the intended concept.
- **F** meditation, illness or waiting.
- **G** treat the device as an objective referee.
- **H** misclassify routines organised differently.

38. An algorithm trained on one population may

- **A** produce missing intervals associated with demanding work.
- **B** remove the need to define an activity.
- **C** protect privacy while reducing the evidence retained.
- **D** prove that continuous data are neutral.
- **E** test whether a method measures the intended concept.
- **F** meditation, illness or waiting.
- **G** treat the device as an objective referee.
- **H** misclassify routines organised differently.

39. Blurring images and deleting segments can

- **A** produce missing intervals associated with demanding work.
- **B** remove the need to define an activity.
- **C** protect privacy while reducing the evidence retained.
- **D** prove that continuous data are neutral.
- **E** test whether a method measures the intended concept.
- **F** meditation, illness or waiting.
- **G** treat the device as an objective referee.
- **H** misclassify routines organised differently.

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40. A good validation study should

A produce missing intervals associated with demanding work.

B remove the need to define an activity.

C protect privacy while reducing the evidence retained.

D prove that continuous data are neutral.

E test whether a method measures the intended concept.

F meditation, illness or waiting.

G treat the device as an objective referee.

H misclassify routines organised differently.

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Writing

IELTS Academic Practice Set 37 - Writing

60 minutes

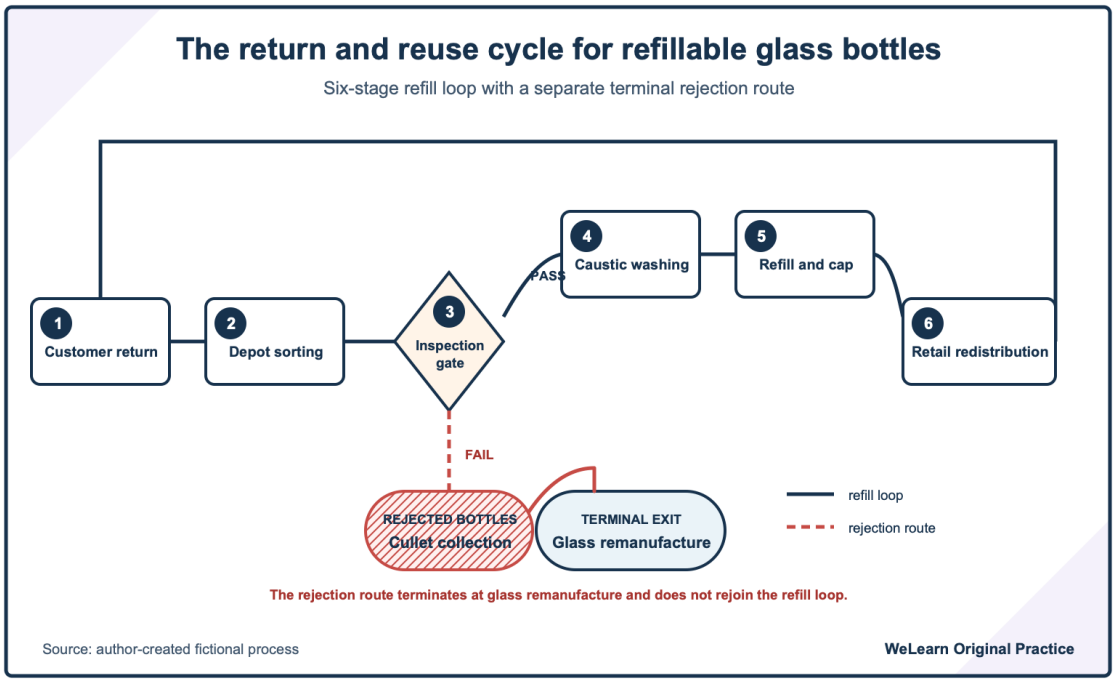
1

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

The visual below shows the return and reuse cycle for refillable glass bottles.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

Write at least 150 words.



2

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.

Some people believe that restaurants and cafés should be required to provide free drinking water to anyone who asks, even if that person does not buy anything.

To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

Write at least 250 words.

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Speaking

IELTS Speaking Practice Set 37

Part 1

- Good morning. My name is Helen Morris.
- What is your full name?
- What should I call you?
- Which hairbrush or comb do you use most often?
- When do you choose a comb instead of a brush?
- How often do you use lifts?
- What do you usually do while you are waiting for a lift?
- For which occasions do you try to arrive early?
- How do you feel when you have to wait for someone?

Part 2

Describe a person who improved a routine.

You should say:

- who the person was and what routine was involved
- what change the person made
- how other people responded

and explain why the change had a lasting effect.

- Did the change make the routine easier for you personally?
- Does this person still suggest improvements now?

Part 3

- Which employees usually notice inefficient routines first, and why?
- Why might staff resist a small change even when it seems sensible?
- Should leaders or employees take greater responsibility for improving daily processes?
- Why do useful changes sometimes fail to spread to other workplaces?

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Objective answer sheets

Listening

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
15		35	
16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Reading

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
15		35	
16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Writing response paper

Task 1 - response page 1 of 2

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Speaking notes

Use notes only for the permitted preparation time.

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